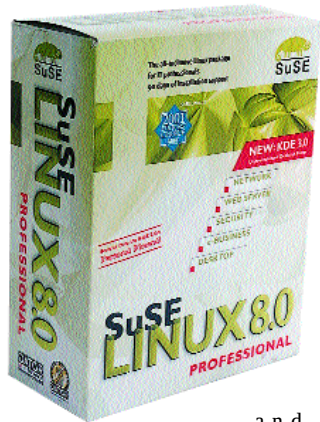


SuSE 8.0 Professional

An OS to suite your wallet

If stability is what you crave, then you should consider SuSE 8.0 Professional. This version offers enhanced features and performance. The improvements include KDE 3.0, XWindow and GNOME 1.4.1 RC1, latest kernel 2.4.18



and SuSE Firewall 2. The new YaST2 includes all the winning features of YaST1 and incorporates other improvements such as clearer splash and boot screens with a Web-style link menu for installation options.

We tested SuSE 8.0 on a P4 2.0 GHz based PC with 256 MB DDR RAM, a 40 GB Seagate Barracuda drive and



YaST2 Control Center offers a simple interface to manage SuSE 8.0

an MSI MAX2 BLR motherboard. The installation was smooth with no prompting for the partition on which the OS should be installed—good for new users but

advanced users may find this inconvenient if they have set aside a partition specifically for Linux.

Upon starting, SuSE 8.0 wasn't able to detect the GeForce4 MX 440 graphics card. The RPM for the card is available on the nVidia Web site for this version of SuSE. The network card (Intel Pro10/100) was detected without any problem and the machine was on the network the moment the settings were entered.

For accessing Windows based machines on the network, SuSE 8.0 provides the Samba 2.2.23a file and print server. However, the network access wasn't as fast as on a Windows machine and there was a slight lag before the folder was displayed. Version 8.0 supports all major protocols such as TCP/IP, IPX, Samba, token ring ARCnet and ham radio. It also has built-in support for DSL, ISDN, PPP Dial-up and DHCP. All this essentially means that you won't need to download any RPM or updates to get the machine

on the network or browse the Internet through a modem or the LAN. You can even run a Web server using Apache, the default Web server built into SuSE 8.0. You need some amount of expertise to configure it, but if you've been using Linux for a while, this shouldn't be too difficult. The

documentation provided with the OS has scanty information on setting up Apache; more detailed information is available at usr/local/httpd.

SuSE 8.0 Professional has decent multimedia capabilities. XMMS (X MultiMedia System), a substitute for Winamp, looks similar to Winamp and is easy to operate. The ALSA Mixer is a sound mixer that you can use to create your own sound effects and music. The aRTs is the KDE sound server which lets you listen to MP3 tracks while playing games. Broadcast2000 is a utility that can record and edit audio and video.

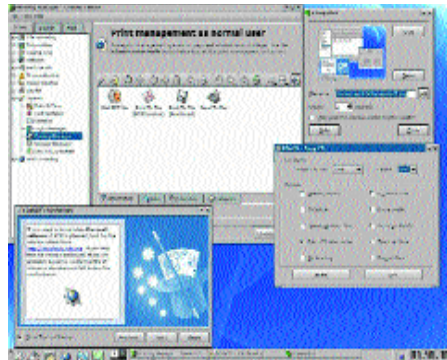
StarOffice 5.2, which is capable of opening MS Excel and Word files, comes bundled with SuSE 8.0. The package is a bit heavy on the system and those with an older and slower processor will

and KGhostView for viewing PDF files. StarImpress is the presentation application within StarOffice 5.2, whereas StarImage will be useful for those who need an image-editing tool. KMail is the mail application in KDE 3.0. It's easy to set up and apart from the regular feature of sending and receiving mail, it also allows you to define filters to sort your mail. PGP and GnuPG mail encryption is also incorporated in KMail to enhance security.

All in all, SuSE 8.0 has a host of features. Its price makes it a viable and robust solution for enterprise-level users and also for the home user who would not want to

spend extra on features, which are not built into the Windows OS such as an Office suite, a Web server, multimedia players and a sound mixer.

Besides these integrated features, the installation has become very easy and the detail documentation makes



The Printing Manager makes it easy to print documents under SuSE 8.0

even the new user comfortable with the knitty gritty of the Linux OS.

have to wait for a couple of seconds for the application to open. If you haven't used StarOffice before, it will take some time to understand the icons and their functions. Apart from this, the application works just fine, whether you are creating formulas in a spreadsheet or formatting text in the word processor.

Also included is the Adobe Acrobat Reader 4.0

SPECIFICATIONS
8 CDs (including online documentation and three manuals) and one DVD containing the entire application.

Minimum System Requirements: Pentium class processor, 650 MB hard disk space, 32 MB RAM

Price: Rs 3,500
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SuSE 8.0 Professional		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	